Lesson Plan: Conclusion Paragraph

Students will learn how to write an effective conclusion that goes beyond merely restating their thesis and main ideas.

STUDENTS WILL…

- Understand the function of a conclusion
- Learn about rhetorical questions
- Write their conclusions

MATERIALS NEEDED

Slide deck · Student laptops/chromebooks and access to yawp.school

Optional Opening: Review

1. Review assessment questions about critical essays. Ask the class first, then reveal the answer on the next slide.

   SLIDES 2-13

The Lesson

1. At this point, most students should be near or at completion of their body paragraphs.
2. If so, make sure that they have advanced their documents to the **“Conclusion Paragraph”** module on yawp.school.
3. Today we will focus on writing a conclusion. Using the slides, debunk the myth that good conclusions “restate the thesis and main ideas of an essay.” (Note: even if you have been taught this, or taught it yourself, please do accept that it’s a bland and unimaginative way to end an essay.)

   SLIDES 14-16
4. Using the slides, discuss the definition of “conclusion” as a deduction that one makes based on available information.

   SLIDES 17-19
5. Read the conclusion from the sample essay to show a good alternative to repeating yourself.

   SLIDES 21, 25
6. Remind students about the power of the **rhetorical question** and show them the **suggested conclusion structure.**

   SLIDES 20-24

7. Close with the **house analogy:** the conclusion walks the reader back to the front door, points out the neighborhood, and leaves gracefully, instead of touring every room again.

SLIDE 26

8. NOTE: Some students may still be working on their body paragraphs, which is ok. Let them continue writing their essays wherever they are. Teaching the conclusion paragraph lesson will allow them to finish when they get to this step.

Writing Activity: Students write their conclusions.

1. This part typically goes pretty fast: once students have finished their body paragraphs, they really are in the home stretch, and the suggested structure gives them the path to the finish line.

SLIDE 27

2. As you work the room, pay attention to students' rhetorical questions. Sometimes they may not fully comprehend how to position themselves with a good, relevant question that provides a springboard for final thoughts. For example, students will ask an overly simple question or simply not know what to say. Help them through these moments.

Adapted from Brian Connell's lesson plan for the YAWP! Writing Program, with slide numbers for the new deck. The house analogy step is added to match the deck.